

Mortgage Renewal Checklist

Don't let your mortgage auto-renew at a bad rate — this checklist walks you through every step

6 Months Before Renewal

- Note your exact renewal date (on your original mortgage documents)
- Check your current rate and remaining balance
- Review your financial situation — income changes, debts, plans to sell?
- Start researching current rates at ratehub.ca and ratespy.com
- Contact a mortgage agent — no cost to you, they shop all lenders
- Lenders can legally offer renewal terms 120-180 days early

Understanding Your Options

Fixed Rate — Rate locked for the term (1-5 years)

- Best when: rates are low and you want payment certainty
- Current 5-year fixed: approximately 3.99% (June 2026)

Variable Rate — Fluctuates with Bank of Canada prime rate

- Best when: rates are expected to drop
- Current variable: approximately 3.30% (prime minus discount)

Open vs Closed — Open allows penalty-free payout, costs more

- Most homeowners choose closed — lower rate, standard penalties

Documents You'll Need

- Recent pay stubs (last 2 pay periods) or T1 Generals if self-employed
- Last 2 years of NOAs (Notice of Assessment) from CRA
- Bank statements (last 90 days)
- Current mortgage statement showing balance and rate
- Property tax bill (current year)
- Photo ID (government-issued)

Negotiation Tips

- Never accept your lender's first renewal offer — always negotiate

- Get quotes from at least 3 lenders before deciding
- A mortgage agent does this for free — they're paid by the lender
- Switching lenders at renewal costs nothing if timed correctly
- Ask about cash-back offers — some lenders offer up to \$3,000
- If staying with your lender, ask to match a competitor's rate in writing

Self-Employed? Extra Steps

- Gather last 2 years of T1 Generals and NOAs
- Prepare 6 months of business bank statements
- Have your accountant write an income confirmation letter
- Check if you qualify for stated income programs
- Self-employed borrowers often get better rates by working with a broker

30 Days Before Renewal

- Confirm your chosen lender and rate in writing
- Review all terms: prepayment privileges, penalties, portability
- Sign renewal documents — don't miss the deadline
- Set a calendar reminder for your next renewal date
- Update your home insurance if switching lenders

Get Expert Help — Free

Paul Malandrino, Mortgage Agent Level 2 (FSRA #M25000307) at Vaughan Mortgage Group specializes in renewals and self-employed borrowers across the GTA. No cost to you — book a free consultation at vaughanmortgagegroup.ca